

Roommate Payment Agreement templates, legal eviction prep checklists, financial protection guides — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

DOCUMENT FINANCIAL AGREEMENTS

- ☐ **Document Financial Agreements, Item 1:** Download and complete the Payment Hierarchy Agreement template with your actual rent amount, due date, and grace period, then print and sign two copies to create a documented financial commitment that holds up under pressure.
- ☐ **Document Financial Agreements, Item 2:** Specify exactly when rent is due including the time of day and define your grace period explicitly, because vague deadlines like "first of the month" give your roommate wiggle room to be late without consequence.
- ☐ **Document Financial Agreements, Item 3:** Assign a concrete late payment fee and payment order hierarchy so that when money is tight, your roommate knows exactly what happens and which bills take priority over others.
- ☐ **Document Financial Agreements, Item 4:** Establish a joint rent account at your existing bank or credit union and set up automatic transfers from each roommate five to seven days before rent is due, removing the Venmo chase entirely.

BUILD LEGAL PROTECTIONS

- ☐ **Build Legal Protections, Item 1:** Create a written lease addendum that transforms your verbal roommate agreement into a legally binding document, because memory is malleable and your word alone won't hold up if you need to take formal action.
 - ☐ **Build Legal Protections, Item 2:** Require signed written acknowledgments from your roommate for every payment, partial payment, and broken promise, building a paper trail that documents the pattern of non-payment for potential legal use.
 - ☐ **Build Legal Protections, Item 3:** Research your state's specific laws regarding roommate agreements, what constitutes a valid financial contract between unrelated individuals, and the legal requirements for initiating eviction proceedings.
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- ☐ **Build Legal Protections, Item 4:** Consult with a landlord-tenant attorney about your specific situation before taking any formal action, because procedures and timelines vary by jurisdiction and a misstep can compromise your case.

ENFORCE AND COLLECT

- ☐ **Enforce and Collect, Item 1:** Send written payment reminders via text or email before and after the due date passes, because this creates timestamped documentation showing you gave clear notice before escalating to formal collection efforts.
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- ☐ **Enforce and Collect, Item 2:** Issue formal written demand notices that reference the signed Payment Hierarchy Agreement and specify exact amounts owed, because informal requests don't carry the weight needed to compel payment.
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- ☐ **Enforce and Collect, Item 3:** Make documented collection attempts every three to five days during the grace period, keeping records of dates and responses to demonstrate good faith effort if legal proceedings become necessary.
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- ☐ **Enforce and Collect, Item 4:** Prepare for small claims court by organizing your signed agreement, payment records, and communication history, because the documented structure you built protects you legally and makes recovery realistic.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.